

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

NAWO-DHAN (New Agriculture Wealth Opportunities Driving Horticulture and Agribusiness Network Project): Vegetables, fruits and commercial crop farming has emerged as one of India's fastest growing and most profitable sectors, driven by rising demand for fresh and frozen produce both domestically and internationally. In Kerala, a unique initiative called “NAWO-DHAN,” implemented by the Department of Agriculture (DoA) through the Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) Kerala Agro Business Company “KABCO”, aims to harness the potential of vacant, fallow, and underutilized land for hi-tech commercial farming. This program would promote advanced agricultural production practices including horticulture, protected cultivation, precision farming, hi-tech intercropping, hydroponics, apiculture, etc. By capitalizing on these unutilized land resources, NAWO-DHAN will aim to boost production levels, add value, generate employment, foster self-reliance, create valuable export opportunities and drive focused sector growth resulting in a major boost to the Kerala’s economy. Primary objective of NAWO-DHAN project is to identify and cultivate high-value fruits, vegetables and commercial crops suitable for international markets; develop a sustainable and profitable farming model; enhance the income of farmers and Agripreneurs through export-oriented agriculture; promote modern and scientific farming techniques and to establish Kerala as a key exporter of high-value agricultural produce.

1. KABCO: KERALA AGRO BUSINESS COMPANY LIMITED (KABCO) is a Public Limited Company, incorporated under the Companies Act as a Company limited by Shares. It is classified as State Govt company and is registered at RoC-Ernakulam and vide GO(Ms) 74/2024/Agri dated 08.07.2024 KABCO has been nominated by the Government of Kerala as the Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV) to implement NAWODHAN.

2. Role of KABCO in NAWO-DHAN

1. KABCO will serve as the central coordinator for all parties involved under NAWO-DHAN, overseeing the planning and implementation of projects.
2. KABCO, in collaboration with the Department of Agriculture, Government of Kerala, will facilitate the identification of vacant or underutilized land for commercial farming. This includes land available with PSUs, Government Departments/institutions, NGOs, trusts, and private lands in Kerala.
3. Through Department of Agriculture, KABCO will also advise and provide guidance to the interested parties involved in NAWO-DHAN project in terms of providing information on project preparation, technical guidance on land and crop selection, costings, market related insights and other related information required for successful planning and implementation of the projects under NAWO-DHAN.
4. KABCO will also organize matchmaking process and activities to connect interested parties with the projects, focusing on exports and international markets. This process will be governed by a service level agreement between the parties involved.

5. KABCO will inform the applicants/interested parties if they wanted to visit the proposed land for NAWO-DHAN.

3. Benefit to the Landowners under NAWO-DHAN

1. Effective utilization of land, water and other resources leads to enhancement of land value.
2. Facilitate transactions between the parties (Landowners, KABCO & Farmers, farmer groups) as per Service Level Agreement (SLA) and parties will be benefited with monetary share from the cultivable land.
3. NAWO-DHAN supports for successful planning and implementation of commercial farming.
4. Effective utilization of interspace between the main crop leads to increase in revenue generation.
5. Long term sustainability of agriculture initiatives will be taken care with prioritizing soil quality and environmental aspects through this project.

4.Scope of Requirements

NAWO-DHAN would like to explore the vacant lands, fallow lands, and underutilized land for hi-tech commercial farming primarily those owned by/available with PSUs, Government Departments/institutions, NGOs, trusts, private lands, etc. in Kerala.

5. The following criteria regarding the land must be fulfilled for submitting an EOI:

1. It should be free from all encumbrances and with legally clear titles.
2. It should be easily approachable from existing roads.
3. It should be free from obstructions and encroachments.
4. The primary requirement is for land parcels of at least 10 acres in a single location. However, smaller parcels of no less than 3 acres at a single site may also be considered, provided the land is suitable for cultivation.
5. Basic enabling facilities such as water, electricity, etc. should be available/accessible.
6. Bills pertaining to municipality taxes or other taxes, water and electricity for the building should be regularly paid and updated.
7. There should not be any pending litigation on the land being proposed for the project.
8. Applicant should furnish all the related details through the online facility enabled.

After scrutinizing the EOI of the landowners, the land feasibility studies with an expert committee will be conducted for shortlisting the lands suitable under NAWO-DHAN.

6.Submission of EOIs and Shortlisting

An online web portal associated with KABCO website has been developed for the submission of EOI. Interested applicants shall submit the EOI through the designated digital form, filling required fields and uploading necessary documents.

KABCO will review the responses and may seek further clarifications and information from certain respondents. These requests for clarifications or information may take the form of communication by telephone, in writing or e-mails. KABCO will not bear any costs relating to the preparation and submission of the EOI responses.

7. Documents to be submitted by the Applicants

1. Private Firms, Individuals – Possession Certificate & Latest Tax Receipt & Aadhaaram as single pdf.
2. Govt Institutions- Application form submission only.

8. Land feasibility studies

1. An expert committee formed under NAWO-DHAN to conduct feasibility studies for accessing land suitability for the intended agricultural activities. This process includes evaluating various factors to ensure that the land can support the desired crops.
2. This process involves studies on soil, drainage capability, climate and weather pattern, water availability, topography, biodiversity, soil erosion and conservation, infrastructure and accessibility, legal and regulatory factors, economic viability, environmental and social safeguards.

KABCO will organize matchmaking process to connect shortlisted lands (landowners) and interested farmers/farmer groups by executing Service Level Agreement (SLA).

9. Important Notice

No Brokers please!

The KERALA AGRO BUSINESS COMPANY LIMITED reserves the right to have negotiations with any or all, accept or reject any or all the EOIs received or annul this process at any time without assigning any reason whatsoever.

The EOI does not constitute a solicitation. KABCO reserves the right to change or cancel the requirements at any time during the EOI and / or solicitation process. Thus, submitting a response to this EOI does not automatically guarantee that your company will be considered for receipt of the solicitation If / when issued.

The expression of interest must be submitted directly by the landowner or the representative of the landowner who is a holder of a valid power of attorney. Kindly be informed that the KABCO does not subscribe to agent fees under any circumstances, and this is to be stipulated in the contract.